its existence through what it should do with regard to meeting the needs of the individual citizens, and the state is only entitled to power if it meets the needs of its citizens. The state therefore has an obligation under the social contract to build institutions and to protect both private and public interests (Ritter and Bondanella 1988). It is an open question whether the Pakistani state has adequately built and maintained these institutions to safeguard Pakistani citizens, and as made clear from the observation by the student in the focus group, many perceive that these safeguards are not equally present for all citizens.

Globalization and state responsibility

At this point it is worth remembering that the relationship between the individual and the state is linked to the particular form of the nation state, which changes over time and is often related to social revolutions. State–citizen relations have not remained static, neither has the social contract. In low-income countries, citizenship is more likely to vary between democracies and military dictatorships. However, even when there is no democracy, and consequently a lack of rights (as opposed to duties), there is still a reduced form of citizenship as states can maintain some level of state responsibility and provide social goods to their citizens. Kirstein and Voigt write about the kinds of dictatorships that avoid a revolution and the risk of being overthrown (also called 'moderate exploitation') (Kirstein and Voigt 2006). These types of dictators do care about the state responsibility side of the social contract, thereby fulfilling a limited part of their citizens' rights.

Today globalization is credited with altering the concept of the state quite fundamentally across the globe (Kuisma 2008). In the era of globalization neoliberal policies have ensured the centrality of the market and this new order raises questions about the role of the state, especially since many hyperglobalists such as Francis Fukuyama and Thomas Friedman will insist that globalization actually entails a withering away of the state. Olssen and Peters (2005) have pointed out that globalization has not resulted in a reduction of state power, but rather in a shifting of such power to new areas whereby the state's role has moved from that of a provider of social and public services to one of a regulator. Consequently, neoliberalism is not about less state control but rather represents a new form of state involvement (Wrigley 2007). In Pakistan, neoliberalism has been further reinforced under the IMF and the World Bank's Structural Adjustment